

API Keys User Guide

Guide for Property Management Companies
Managing External System Access to Your Company Data

What is an API Key?

An **API Key** is a long, secure passcode that allows external systems—rather than a human user—to connect to the OXS system to automatically read or update your company's data without requiring manual login.

Unlike a standard user, an API key does not have a username, password, or login screen. It is automatically transmitted alongside every request sent by the external system, allowing our system to securely identify your company.

Important Note

An API key identifies your **company**, not a specific user. Every action performed using the key will be logged under the name of the API key itself, rather than an individual employee.

Why Use API Keys?

API keys allow you to integrate OXS seamlessly with other software systems you use. For example:

- Display tenant service requests directly on your private website or mobile app.
- Automatically submit service tickets from an external application without logging into OXS.
- Export tenant debt data directly into internal reports or accounting software.
- Synchronize lists of buildings, apartments, and tenants across external platforms.
- Generate automated periodic reports without requiring manual data extraction.

How to Activate the Service

API access is disabled by default. To enable this service, please contact **OXS Support**.

Once activated, a new tab titled "**API Keys**" will appear in the *Company Settings* menu. If the service is not activated, this tab will remain hidden.

Caution

If the API service is deactivated in the future, all existing API keys created for your company will instantly cease to function.

Modules and Access Levels

Each API key is strictly restricted to a **single module** and a **single access level**. This design ensures that a key intended for reading financial data cannot modify or delete service tickets.

Module	Access Levels	Scope & Permissions
Service Requests	Read-Only / Full Control	View service requests, create new requests, update status, and delete.
Tenant Debts	Read-Only	View tenant debt balances, payment details, and outstanding amounts.
General Information	Read-Only	Retrieve list of buildings, apartments, residing tenants, and payment histories.

The **"Read-Only"** permission allows data viewing only. The **"Full Control"** permission grants permission to create, update, and delete entries—and is exclusively available for the *Service Requests* module.

If access to multiple modules is required, simply create a dedicated key for each module.

Managing Keys in the New Tab

The API Keys tab resides under **Company Settings** and serves as the centralized dashboard for managing your keys.

Creating a New Key

Click on **"Create New Key"** and complete the required fields:

- **Name (Required):** A clear descriptor to identify the key later (e.g., *"Company Website"* or *"Accounting Integration"*). Because the name is the sole way to identify a key over time, this field is mandatory.
- **Module:** Select the target system domain the key is allowed to access.
- **Access Level:** Choose between *Read-Only* or *Full Control* (depending on the module).
- **Expiration Date:** If left unspecified, keys will automatically expire after 1 year by default.

Key Display Policy (Displayed Once Only)

Immediately upon creation, the full API key will be displayed. **This is the only time the full key will ever be visible.** OXS does not store plain-text keys and cannot recover lost keys. Copy the key immediately and store it securely. If a key is lost, it cannot be retrieved; you must perform a rotation to issue a new key.

In the overview table, only the first 4 characters (e.g., `oxs_...`) will be shown for identification purposes.

Key Rotation (Replacing a Key)

Rotation generates a brand-new key in place of an existing one. Use this when a key needs replacement—such as when a key is compromised, or as part of routine periodic security procedures.

To prevent service downtime during rotation, the old key will remain active for an additional **24 hours**. During this window, you must update the external system with the new key. After 24 hours, the old key will be permanently blocked.

Note: Initiating rotation starts an active countdown. Only trigger key rotation when an administrator is ready to update the connected systems immediately.

Disabling and Enabling

Disabling a key immediately revokes its access. A disabled key can be re-enabled at any time. This is the fastest security response if you suspect a key leak—disable immediately, investigate later.

Usage Tracking

The **"Usage"** button displays request volume metrics per key, broken down by month and domain. This helps verify active integration health and spot abnormal request spikes.

Key Statuses Overview

Status	Description
ACTIVE	The key is operating normally with valid permissions.
IN ROTATION	A new key was generated; the old key remains functional until the 24-hour overlap window expires.

Status	Description
DISABLED	Manually blocked. Can be reactivated at any time.
EXPIRED	The expiration date has passed. The key is inactive and a new key must be created.

Expiration and Reminders

Every key includes an expiration date—**there are no perpetual keys**. This ensures forgotten keys do not pose long-term security liabilities.

- Default validity is set to 1 year from creation (customizable up to 2 years max).
- Email reminders are sent at **30 days, 7 days, and 1 day** prior to expiration.
- The key table displays remaining days. When under 30 days remain, the day count will highlight in red.
- Once expired, generate a new key and update the integrated system.

Rate Limits

To maintain system stability and fair resource distribution, rate limits apply to all keys:

- **60 requests per minute**
- **1,000 requests per hour**

If an external system exceeds these limits, requests will be temporarily rejected until the start of the next request window. If your operations require higher throughput, contact **OXS Support**.

Actions Requiring OXS Support

For administrative and security reasons, the following actions cannot be performed directly from the tab:

- **Permanent Key Deletion:** Contact OXS Support (disable the key manually as an immediate alternative).
- **Modifying Rate Limits:** Contact OXS Support for custom throughput limits.
- **Initial API Service Activation:** Performed exclusively by the OXS Support team.

Security Best Practices

Protect Your Credentials

An API key possesses permissions equivalent to a corporate password. Anyone holding the key can access your company data according to the assigned permissions.

- 🔒 **Never send API keys via email, WhatsApp, or unencrypted chat apps.**
- 🔒 **Never store API keys directly in source code or shared public documents.**
- 🔒 **Issue separate keys for each external system**—allowing you to disable or rotate individual keys without disrupting other integrations.
- 🔒 **Apply the principle of least privilege:** always grant the minimum required access level (e.g., choose *Read-Only* if write access is not explicitly required).
- 🔒 **If key exposure is suspected, disable the key immediately** and initiate a rotation.
- 🔒 **Keys are strictly scoped to your company:** attempts to use your key to query another company's data will be rejected automatically.

For support, service activation, custom limits, or permanent key deletion, please reach out to OXS Support.